



Americans Lean Against Invading Cuba — but Republicans Stand Apart

*Public opinion on U.S. military force against Cuba, CHIP50 Wave 38
(fielded May 14–June 1, 2026)*

June 18, 2026

CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel
Nanocentury AI

Abstract

Opposition to using U.S. military force to overthrow the Cuban government outweighs support roughly 2-to-1, and Republicans are the only partisan group where supporters outnumber opponents.

Key findings: (1) A combined 46.3% of Americans oppose using military force against Cuba's government, versus 24.6% who support it; 29.2% neither support nor oppose. (2) Partisanship is the defining divide — Strong Republicans are the only group where a majority supports it (50.3% support vs. 22.1% oppose), while support collapses to 9.4% among Lean Democrats. (3) The youngest adults (18–20) are the most opposed of any age group (60.5% oppose, 11.6% support); support peaks among 31–40-year-olds (30.1%). (4) More-educated Americans oppose at higher rates — 54.2% of graduate-degree holders oppose, versus 39.0% of high-school graduates — while support rates are relatively flat across education. (5) Hispanic respondents are the most supportive racial/ethnic group (28.7% support), and that edge holds under statistical controls. (6) The gender gap (29.6% of men vs. 19.6% of women support) does not survive controls; income shows no consistent pattern.

Data & Methodology

The data presented in this report are drawn from the CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, a nationally representative online survey panel of U.S. adults conducted by Nanocentury AI across multiple fielding waves.

This report focuses on Wave 38 of the CHIP50 panel, with 16,628 respondents (weighted to represent approximately 16,645 U.S. adults). All figures below reflect this single wave; no cross-wave comparisons are implied.

Survey weights are applied throughout to adjust for design effects and ensure population representativeness. All percentages and means reported in this document are weighted population estimates unless otherwise indicated. Unweighted respondent counts (*n*) are provided solely as an indicator of statistical reliability and must not be interpreted as population estimates or used to compute percentages.

Cells with fewer than 10 respondents are suppressed and reported as “—” to protect respondent privacy. Platform usage is measured as a binary indicator (1 = uses platform; 0 = does not use platform). Ordinal response scales encode –99 for skipped or refused responses; these values are automatically excluded from all distributional and regression analyses.

Regression models employ survey-weighted estimation. OLS models report coefficients with heteroskedasticity-consistent standard errors, R^2 , F -statistic, and AIC/BIC. Logistic regression models report log-odds coefficients, odds ratios, McFadden's pseudo- R^2 , and AIC/BIC. Statistical significance is assessed at $\alpha = 0.05$.

Context

The question was fielded in Wave 38 as the United States sharply escalated pressure on Cuba in spring 2026. The Trump administration imposed sweeping new sanctions and expelled Cuban diplomats in February 2026, and congressional Republicans introduced legislation in March authorizing military options for Cuban regime change. This survey captures public opinion at the height of that pressure campaign.

The support_cuba item was asked of a random subsample of Wave 38 respondents — 3,819 of the wave's approximately 16,600 participants — using the wording: "Would you support or oppose the US using military force to overthrow the current Cuban government?" Responses run 1 = strongly oppose to 5 = strongly support, with 3 = neither support nor oppose. A small number of respondents who answered "not sure" are excluded from all calculations.

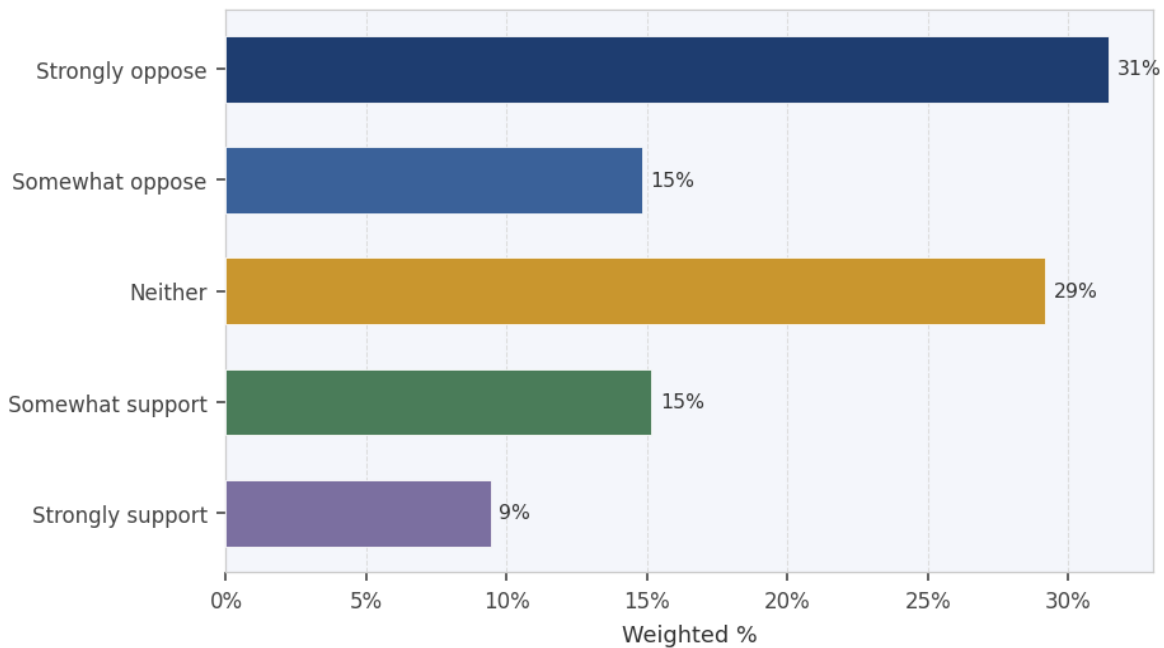
Findings: Overall

Opposition leads support by nearly 2-to-1. A combined 46.3% of Americans oppose using military force against Cuba's government (31.5% strongly), versus 24.6% who support it (9.4% strongly). Another 29.2% neither support nor oppose.

Table 1. Overall opinion on U.S. military force against Cuba (Wave 38; weighted %)

Response	Weighted %
Strongly oppose (1)	31.45
Somewhat oppose (2)	14.81
Neither support nor oppose (3)	29.17
Somewhat support (4)	15.15
Strongly support (5)	9.42
Net oppose (1+2)	46.26
Net support (4+5)	24.57

Note. Weighted % among 3,819 respondents who gave a substantive answer. Net rows are subtotals.

Figure 1. Opinion on U.S. military force against Cuba (Wave 38, weighted %)

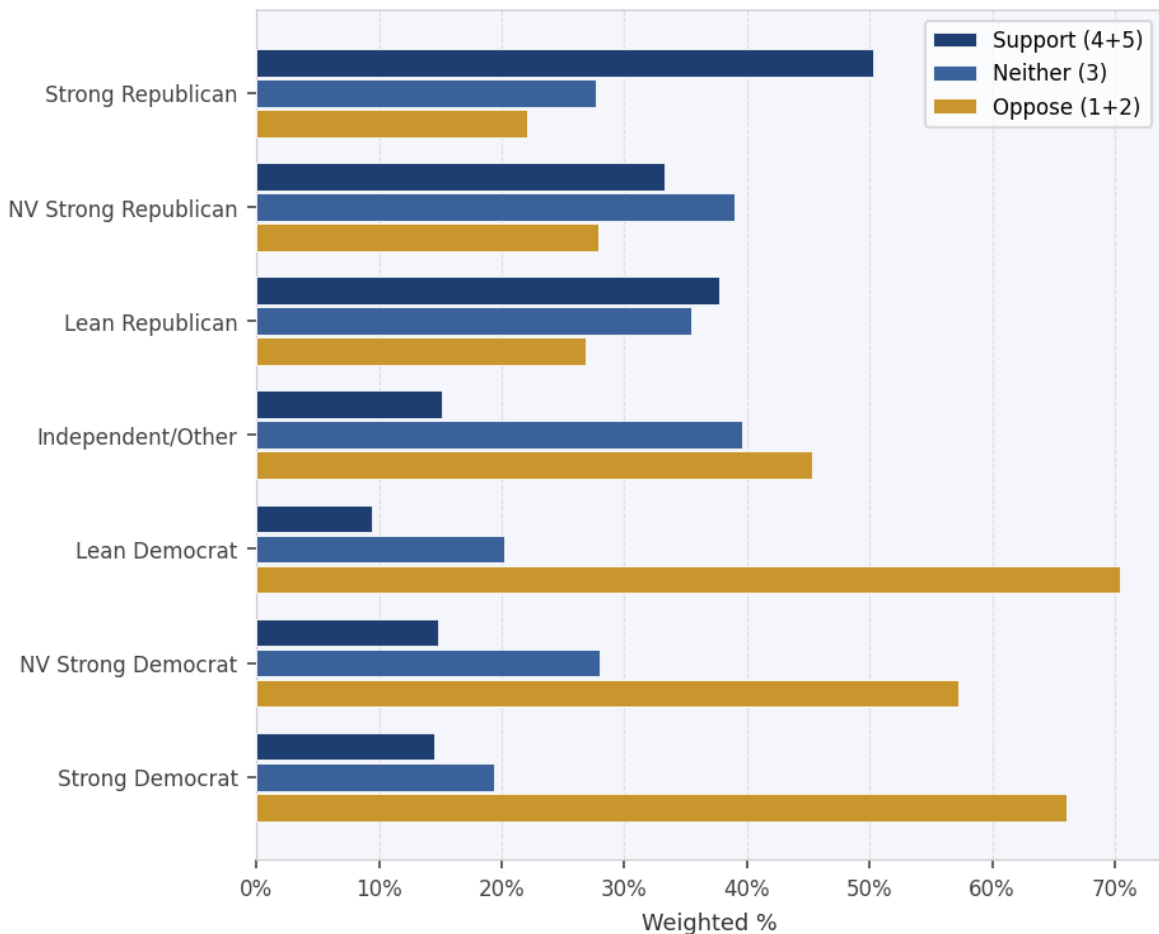
Note. $N = 3,819$ respondents (subsample of Wave 38).

Source. CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, Wave 38.

Findings: By party identification

Partisanship is the sharpest cleavage in the data. Strong Republicans are the only group where a majority supports military force (50.3% support vs. 22.1% oppose). All three Republican groups are net supportive — supporters outnumber opponents. The pattern reverses for all Democratic groups, most sharply among Lean Democrats (70.4% oppose, 9.4% support). Pure Independents are heavily opposed (45.3% oppose, 15.2% support).

In the multivariate model, every partisan group is significantly less supportive than Strong Republicans (all $p < .001$). The gradient is steep: Lean Democrats carry the largest coefficient (−1.55), followed by Strong Democrats (−1.35) and Not-very-strong Democrats (−1.17).

Figure 2. Support, opposition, and neutrality by party identification (Wave 38, weighted %)

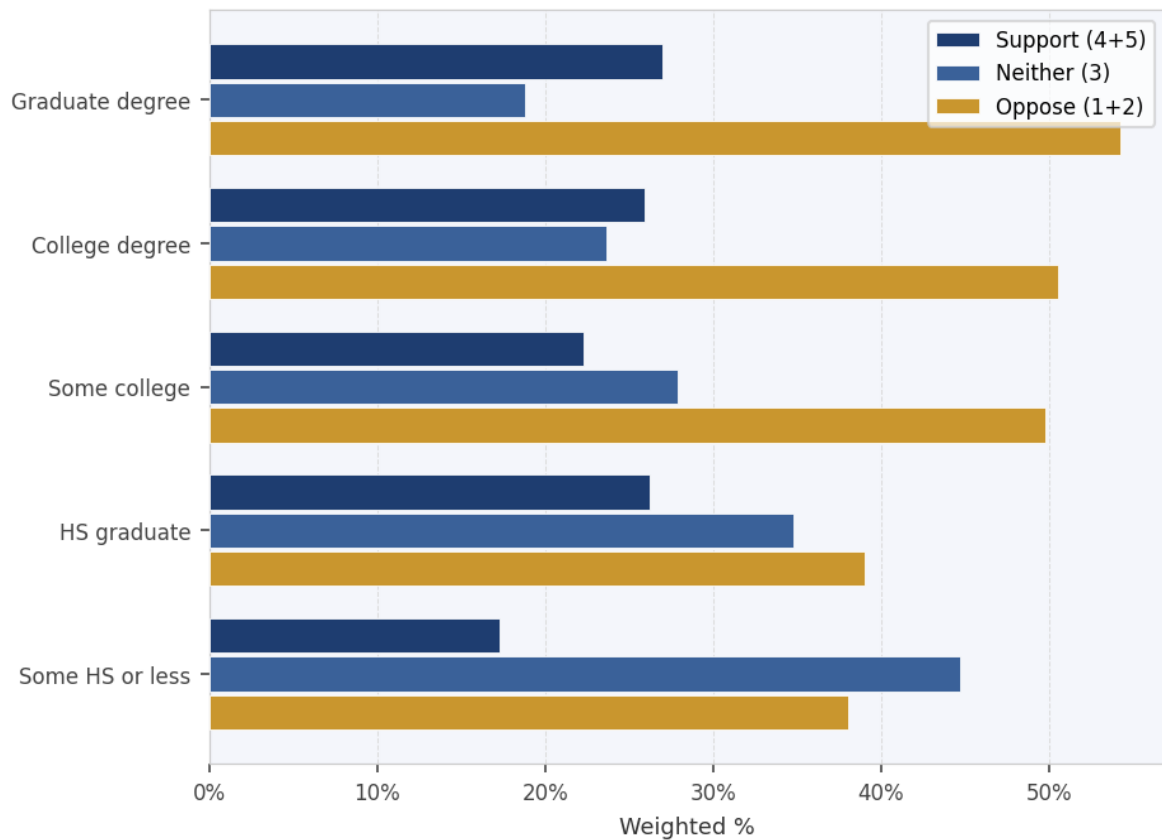
Note. Party7 scale: 1 = Strong Republican ... 7 = Strong Democrat. Tool: `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(support_cuba, party7, wave=38)`.

Source. CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, Wave 38.

Findings: By education

The education pattern is mainly an opposition gradient: opposition rises steadily with education, from 38.0% among those with some high school or less to 54.2% among graduate-degree holders. Support rates, by contrast, are relatively flat across education groups (17–27%).

Under controls, College (-0.21 , $p < .001$), Graduate (-0.27 , $p < .001$), and Some College (-0.15 , $p = .002$) respondents are all significantly less supportive than high-school graduates. The some-high-school-or-less coefficient is not significant (-0.07 , $p = .50$).

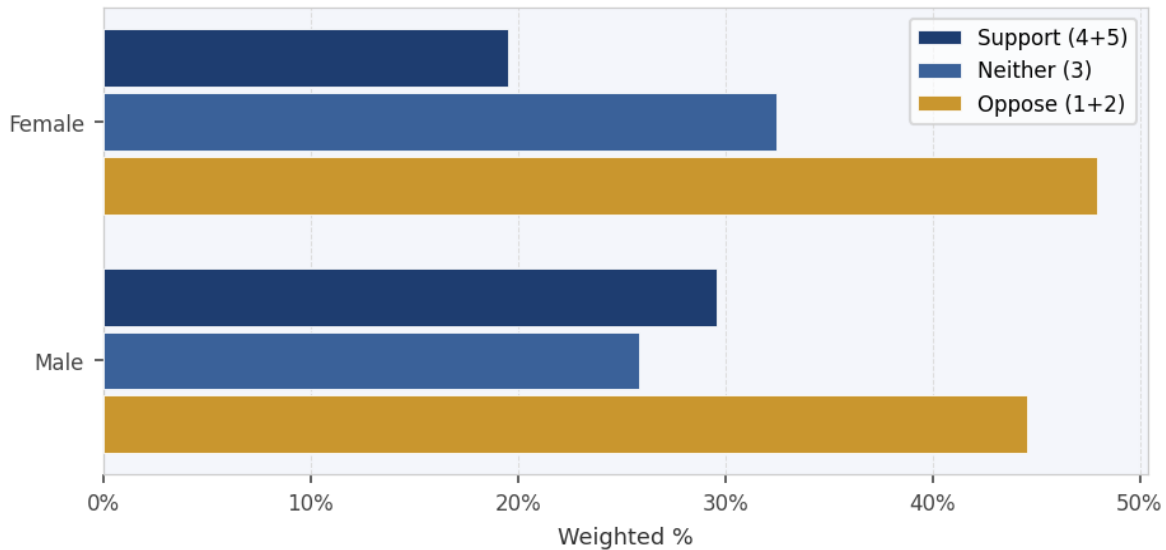
Figure 3. Support, opposition, and neutrality by education (Wave 38, weighted %)

Note. Tool: `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(support_cuba, education_cat, wave=38)`.

Source. CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, Wave 38.

Findings: By gender

Men are descriptively more supportive than women (29.6% vs. 19.6% support). However, this difference does not survive statistical controls — the female coefficient in the regression is -0.05 ($p = .22$), not significant. The descriptive 10-point gap largely reflects the partisan composition of the gender groups, not an independent gender effect.

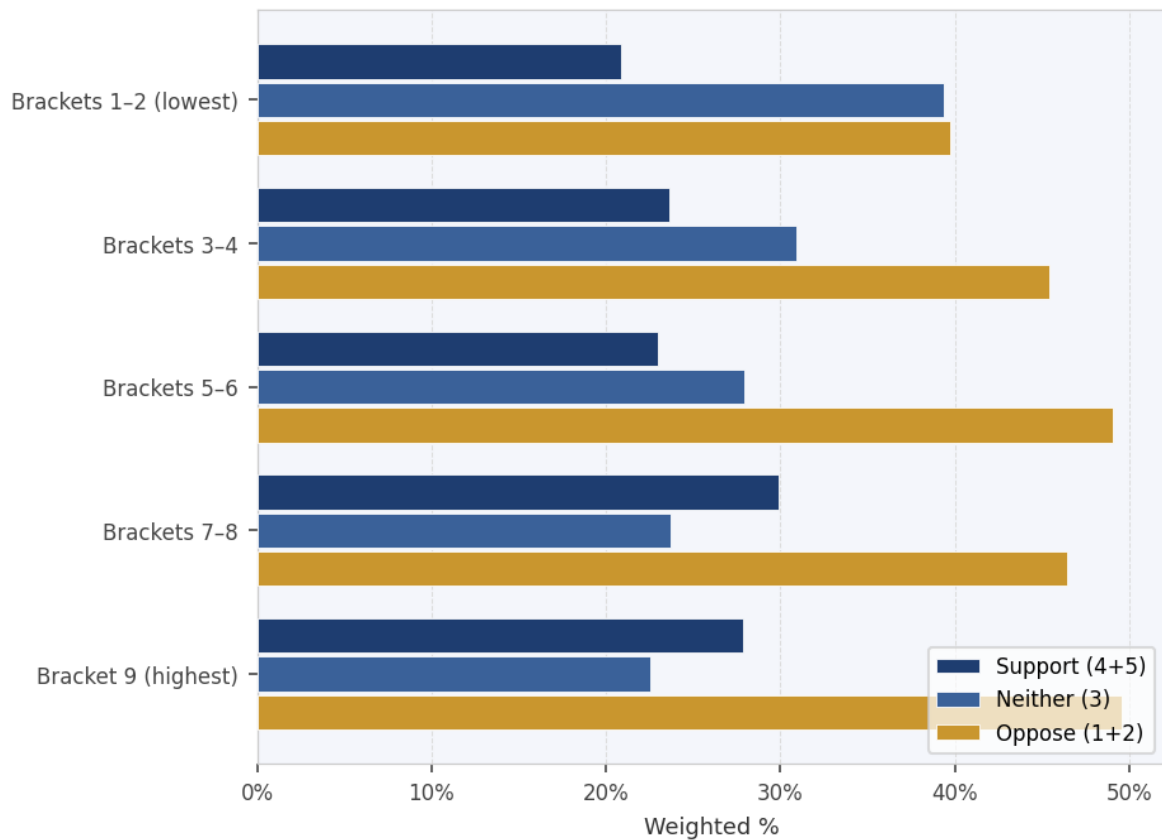
Figure 4. Support, opposition, and neutrality by gender (Wave 38, weighted %)

Note. The descriptive gender gap does not survive controls (regression $p = .22$). Tool: `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(support_cuba, gender, wave=38)`.

Source. CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, Wave 38.

Findings: By income

Support edges up modestly with income — from about 21% in the lowest income pair to 28–30% in the upper-middle pairs — while the share with no opinion (neither) falls as income rises. No income category is significant in the multivariate model (only bracket 5 is marginally significant, -0.22 , $p = .009$, and no monotonic pattern holds). Adjacent brackets are combined by summing weighted population counts; income bracket 10 has suppressed cells and is excluded.

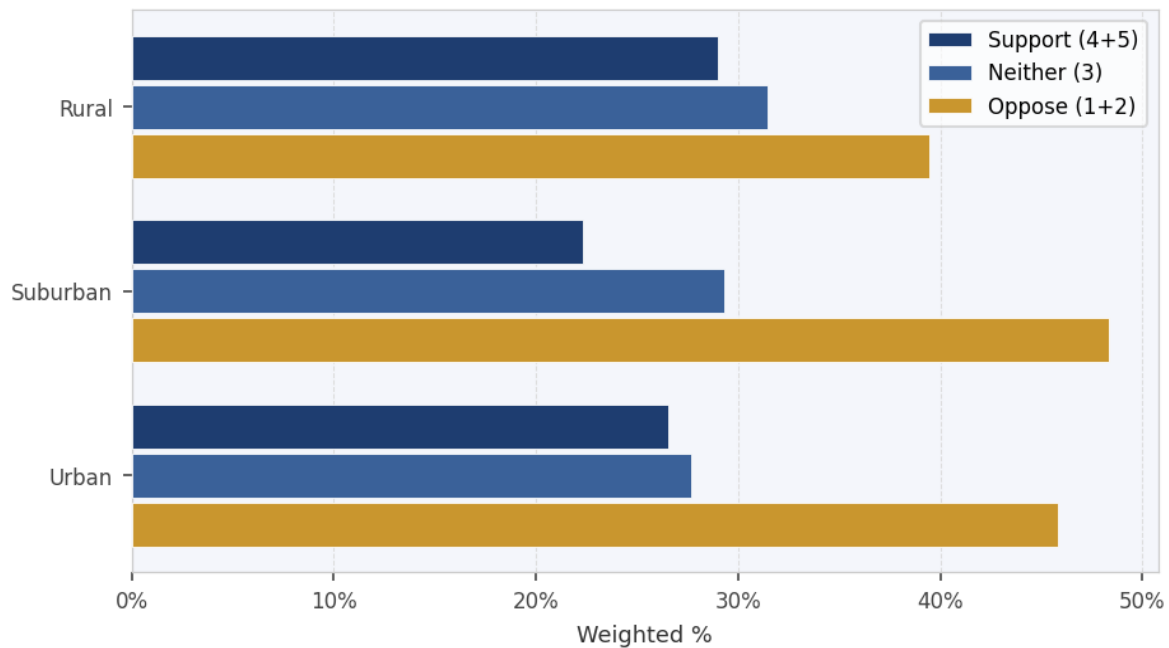
Figure 5. Support, opposition, and neutrality by income bracket (paired, Wave 38, weighted %)

Note. Adjacent brackets combined by summing weighted population counts. Bracket 10 and code 11 (prefer not to say) excluded due to cell suppression. Tool: `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(support_cuba, income_cat_10, wave=38)`.

Source. CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, Wave 38.

Findings: By community type

Suburban respondents are the least supportive group (22.4% support, 48.4% oppose). Both rural and urban residents are more supportive, and both gaps remain significant under controls — rural (+0.12, $p = .028$) and urban (+0.15, $p < .001$) residents are each more supportive than suburbanites after controlling for demographics. This suburban trough is a real, reproducible pattern.

Figure 6. Support, opposition, and neutrality by community type (Wave 38, weighted %)

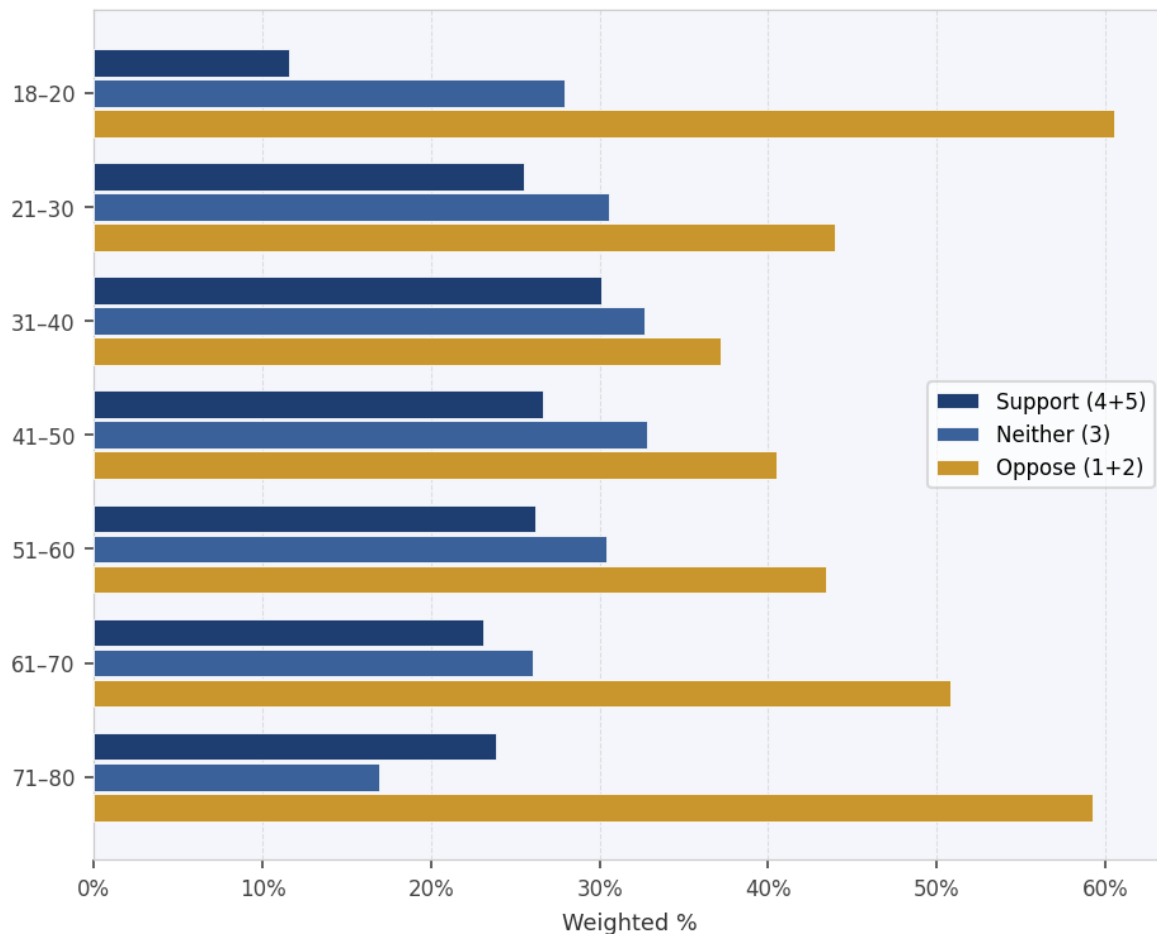
Note. Both rural and urban residents are significantly more supportive than suburban under controls. Tool: `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(support_cuba, urban_type, wave=38)`.

Source. CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, Wave 38.

Findings: By age

The 18–20-year-old group is the most opposed of any age group (60.5% oppose, just 11.6% support). Support then rises to peak in midlife: 30.1% among 31–40-year-olds. From there support falls and opposition rises again through the 60s and 70s.

Under controls, age follows a curvilinear pattern relative to the 18–20 reference: support rises through midlife (21–30: +0.37; 31–40: +0.48; 41–50: +0.40; 51–60: +0.25, all $p < .01$), then flattens — 61–70 (+0.16, $p = .06$) is borderline, and 71–80 and 80+ are not significant. The 80+ age group has several suppressed cells and is excluded from the chart.

Figure 7. Support, opposition, and neutrality by age group (Wave 38, weighted %)

Note. 80 and over group excluded: most response cells suppressed ($n < 10$). Tool: `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(support_cuba, age_cat_8, wave=38)`.

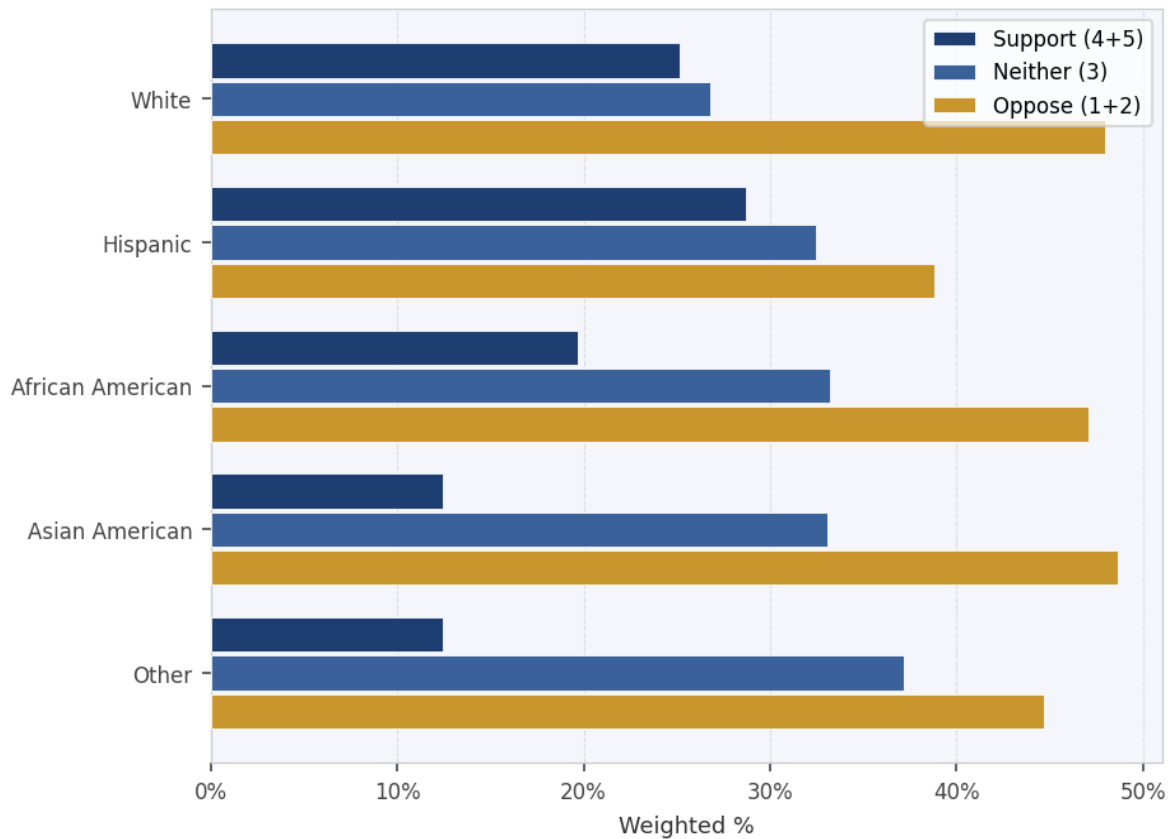
Source. CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, Wave 38.

Findings: By race and ethnicity

Hispanic respondents are the most supportive group (28.7% support) — above White respondents (25.2%), and a gap that remains significant under controls (+0.25, $p < .001$ in the model with race added). African Americans are also significantly more supportive than White respondents after controls (+0.23, $p < .001$), though the descriptive support rate (19.7%) is lower than White (25.2%) — the control absorbs partisan composition. Asian American and Other race categories are not significantly different from White under controls.

Note: "strongly support" cells for Asian American and Other are suppressed ($n < 10$); support totals for those groups are lower bounds.

Figure 8. Support, opposition, and neutrality by race/ethnicity (Wave 38, weighted %)



Note. "Strongly support" suppressed for Asian American and Other ($n < 10$); support values are lower bounds for those groups. Tool: `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(support_cuba, race_cat_5, wave=38)`.

Source. CHIP50 Social Media Demographics Panel, Wave 38.

Further findings: Hispanic support by party

Because the Hispanic finding is notable, the table below splits the Hispanic subsample ($\text{race_hisp} = 1$) by party identification (3-point). The key finding: the Hispanic elevation is concentrated among Democrats. Hispanic Democrats are markedly more supportive than Hispanic Independents, and the Republican subgroup ($n < 175$, strongly oppose cell suppressed) appears highly supportive. Cell sizes in this table are thin ($n = 113\text{--}200$) and should be read as indicative only.

Table 2. Support for military force by Hispanic status and party — distribution (weighted %, Wave 38)

Party	Strongly oppose	Somewhat oppose	Neither	Somewhat support	Strongly support
Hispanic Democrat	33.12	12.30	28.48	17.97	8.13
Hispanic Independent/Other	32.55	12.39	36.87	12.80	5.39
Hispanic Republican	suppressed	12.01	31.29	25.96	22.83

Note. Hispanic subsample only (*race_hisp*=1). "Strongly oppose" cell suppressed for Hispanic Republicans (*n* < 10). Tool: *get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(support_cuba, party3, wave=38, filters={race_hisp: [1]})*.

Methods

Data. CHIP50 (Civic Health and Institutions Project, a 50-State Survey; successor to the COVID States Project), Wave 38, fielded May 14–June 1, 2026 (field dates from wave documentation; wave metadata tool returned null dates). Non-probability online panel, weighted to be population-representative of U.S. adults.

Measure. Outcome *support_cuba*: "Would you support or oppose the US using military force to overthrow the current Cuban government?" — a 1–5 ordinal scale (1 = strongly oppose, 3 = neither, 5 = strongly support). Scale direction confirmed against the questionnaire. The item was asked of 3,819 of the wave's approximately 16,600 respondents.

Estimation. All estimates are survey-weighted (population-representative). The topline is the full weighted five-point distribution. Demographic breakdowns are the weighted percentage in each response category within each group. The regression is a survey-weighted OLS (WLS) of *support_cuba* on six standard demographics with *party7*, *age_cat_8*, and *income_cat_10* treated as categorical (dummy-encoded). A supplementary model adds *race_cat_5*. References: Strong Republican (*party7*=1), High School Graduate, Male, income bracket 1, Suburban, age 18–20.

Significance discipline. Differences are described as meaningful only where the regression coefficient is significant at $p < .05$. The gender gap ($p = .22$) and income coefficients (mostly non-significant) are presented as descriptive only.

Suppression. Cells with $n < 10$ are suppressed. Several cells in the 80 and over age group and in the top income brackets are suppressed; where a combined estimate excludes a suppressed sub-cell it is a lower bound.

Appendix A — Analytic Memo

Multivariate findings (Model 1: without race). Survey-weighted OLS of support_cuba on party7, education_cat, gender, income_cat_10, urban_type, age_cat_8. $n = 3,807$; $R^2 = 0.2125$. References: Strong Republican, HS Graduate, Male, bracket 1, Suburban, age 18–20.

Party dominates. Every group is significantly less supportive than Strong Republicans (all $p < .01$). The gradient: NVS Republican (–0.39), Lean Republican (–0.27), Independent/Other (–1.06), Lean Democrat (–1.55), NVS Democrat (–1.17), Strong Democrat (–1.35). The unusually large Independent coefficient (–1.06) reflects that low-engagement independents — who cluster in category 4 — are distinctly anti-interventionist.

Education is a real, modest negative. College (–0.21), Graduate (–0.27), and Some College (–0.15) respondents are all significantly less supportive than HS graduates (all $p < .01$). Some-HS-or-less is not significant.

Age is curvilinear. Relative to 18–20-year-olds, support rises through midlife: 21–30 (+0.37), 31–40 (+0.48), 41–50 (+0.40), 51–60 (+0.25) — all $p < .01$. Then 61–70 (+0.16, $p = .06$) is borderline; 71–80 and 80+ are not significant. The youngest adults are the most dovish, and the oldest are also relatively opposed — a U-shaped age effect.

Rurality survives controls. Both Rural (+0.12, $p = .028$) and Urban (+0.15, $p < .001$) residents are more supportive than suburbanites.

Gender washes out. Female coefficient = –0.05 ($p = .22$). The descriptive 10-point gender gap largely reflects partisan composition.

Income is null overall. No consistent monotonic pattern; bracket 5 is the only significant coefficient (–0.22, $p = .009$) and this is unlikely to be substantively meaningful without a broader gradient.

Model 2 (adding race, $R^2 = 0.219$). Hispanic (+0.25, $p < .001$) and African American (+0.23, $p < .001$) respondents are significantly more supportive than White respondents after controls. Asian American (+0.03, ns) and Other (–0.12, ns) are not significant.

Candidate storylines. (1) 'Partisanship, not Cuba.' Strong Republicans are the only majority-supportive group (50.3%), while support collapses to single digits among Lean Democrats (9.4%) — a 41-point chasm. (2) 'Even amid a pressure campaign, the public won't back regime-change force.' Net opposition (46.3%) nearly doubles net support (24.6%) at the moment of peak administration pressure. (3) 'Gen Z is the most dovish.' The 18–20 cohort is 60.5% opposed, the most opposed of any age group. (4) 'The diploma divide is an opposition divide.' Opposition rises with education while support stays flat — a subtle pattern the means conceal.

Appendix: Reproducibility — MCP Tool Calls

The table below lists, in order, every CHIP50 MCP tool call used to produce the tables and figures in this report. Each call can be re-run verbatim against the same MCP server to reproduce the corresponding result.

1. `get_wave_metadata`

```
get_wave_metadata(wave="38")
```

Wave 38 metadata — field dates, sample sizes

2. `get_ordinal_distribution`

```
get_ordinal_distribution(column="support_cuba", wave="38")
```

Figure 1 / Table 1 — topline distribution of support_cuba

3. `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic`

```
get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(column="support_cuba",  
demographic="party7", wave="38")
```

Figure 2 — support_cuba by 7-point party identification

4. `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic`

```
get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(column="support_cuba",  
demographic="education_cat", wave="38")
```

Figure 3 — support_cuba by education

5. `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic`

```
get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(column="support_cuba",  
demographic="gender", wave="38")
```

Figure 4 — support_cuba by gender

6. `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic`

```
get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(column="support_cuba",  
demographic="income_cat_10", wave="38")
```

Figure 5 — support_cuba by income bracket (10-point)

7. `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic`

```
get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(column="support_cuba",  
demographic="urban_type", wave="38")
```

Figure 6 — support_cuba by community type

8. `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic`

```
get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(column="support_cuba",  
demographic="age_cat_8", wave="38")
```

Figure 7 — support_cuba by age group

9. `get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic`

```
get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(column="support_cuba",  
demographic="race_cat_5", wave="38")
```

*Figure 8 — support_cuba by race/ethnicity***10. get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic**

```
get_ordinal_distribution_by_demographic(column="support_cuba",
demographic="party3", wave="38", filters={"race_hisp": ["1"]})
```

*Table 9 — support_cuba among Hispanic respondents by party***11. run_ols_regression**

```
run_ols_regression(outcome="support_cuba", predictors=["party7", "education_cat",
"gender", "income_cat_10", "urban_type", "age_cat_8"], wave="38",
treat_as_categorical=["party7", "age_cat_8", "income_cat_10"],
reference_levels={"party7": "1", "age_cat_8": "18 to 20", "urban_type": "Suburban",
"education_cat": "High School Graduate", "gender": "Male", "income_cat_10": "1"})
```

*Appendix A — primary OLS regression (Model 1, n=3807, R²=0.2125)***12. run_ols_regression**

```
run_ols_regression(outcome="support_cuba", predictors=["party7", "education_cat",
"gender", "income_cat_10", "urban_type", "age_cat_8", "race_cat_5"], wave="38",
treat_as_categorical=["party7", "age_cat_8", "income_cat_10", "race_cat_5"],
reference_levels={"party7": "1", "age_cat_8": "18 to 20", "urban_type": "Suburban",
"education_cat": "High School Graduate", "gender": "Male", "income_cat_10": "1",
"race_cat_5": "White"})
```

Appendix A — supplementary OLS with race (Model 2, n=3807, R²=0.2186)